

Interactive Systems

Los Del DGIIM, losdeldgiim.github.io

Doble Grado en Ingeniería Informática y Matemáticas
Universidad de Granada

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1. Research Methods for Interactive Systems Design

When designing interactive systems, it is crucial to understand the design space:

- Users: needs and requirements
- Situation: what is the current state of the problem
- Context: location, legislation, culture, etc.

There are different types of research methods:

- Quantitative / Qualitative: Quantitative methods involve collecting and analyzing numerical data, while qualitative methods focus on understanding human behavior and the reasons behind it.
- In situ / In Laboratory: In situ research is conducted in the natural environment of the users, while laboratory research takes place in a controlled setting.
- Unstructured / Structured: Unstructured research allows for more flexibility and exploration, while structured research follows a predefined plan and methodology.

In order to design effective interactive systems, *triangulation* is often used, which involves combining multiple research methods to gain a comprehensive understanding of the design space. During the following sections, we will explore various research methods that can be employed to gather all the needed information.

1.1. Ethnography

1.2. Action Research

1.3. Research through Design

1.4. Field Studies